FREE CHECKLIST

The 6-Month Test

Building an agent takes an afternoon. Keeping it running six months later is another story. These questions help you find out which side your agent is on.

> Answer with an agent in mind that is already in production or about to go live. Tick only what is true today, not what is planned. The agent that delivers value and the agent that is quietly switched off usually differ on three points.

1 Simplify before you scale

Start with the simplest design that meets the use case, and add complexity only when simplicity shows its limits.

- [ ] I can explain in one sentence what the agent does and for whom.
- [ ] Before choosing an agent, I checked whether a deterministic workflow, with no agent, would solve the case.
- [ ] Every extra agent, tool or layer was added because of an observed limitation, not in anticipation of one.
- [ ] The agent has access only to the tools it really needs.

In the book, chapters 3, 6 and 7

2 Build for failure

Every design has to anticipate tool failures, unexpected model responses and malformed user inputs.

- [ ] If the model API or a tool goes down, the agent tells the user something useful instead of going silent.
- [ ] External calls are retried with an increasing wait and a defined limit.
- [ ] A person is alerted when the same failure keeps happening.
- [ ] Response quality is measured on a recurring basis, not only on launch day.

In the book, chapters 14 and 15

3 Govern from the start

Security, privacy and human oversight come in from the first line of the design. That includes compliance with data protection law by default, such as the LGPD in Brazil or the GDPR in Europe.

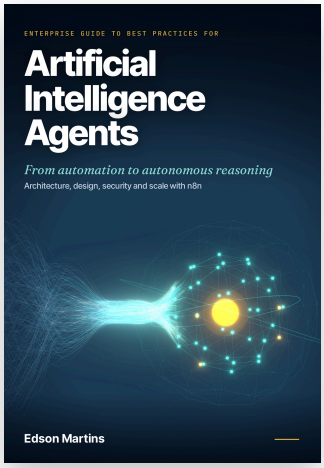
- [ ] There are guardrails on the agent's input and output, including protection against prompt injection.
- [ ] The personal data the agent handles has a defined legal basis under the applicable data protection law.
- [ ] The user has a clear path to talk to a person.
- [ ] The highest-risk actions require human approval before they are carried out.

In the book, chapters 11, 12 and 13

How to read the result

If the agent passes all three criteria, it has a real chance of still being in production six months from now.

If it fails any of them, the countdown has already started, even if nobody has noticed yet.



Enterprise Guide to Best Practices for Artificial Intelligence Agents

The 6-Month Test is the common thread of the book. It has 20 chapters on architecture, guardrails, data privacy, resilience, evaluation and operation with n8n, cases from Klarna, Morgan Stanley, Bradesco and Localiza, ready-to-use templates and workflows to import.

Available on Hotmart, with a 7-day guarantee.

Get the guide

The book's workflows, free on GitHub (English files in the en folder): github.com/edson-martins/guia-agentes-ia-n8n